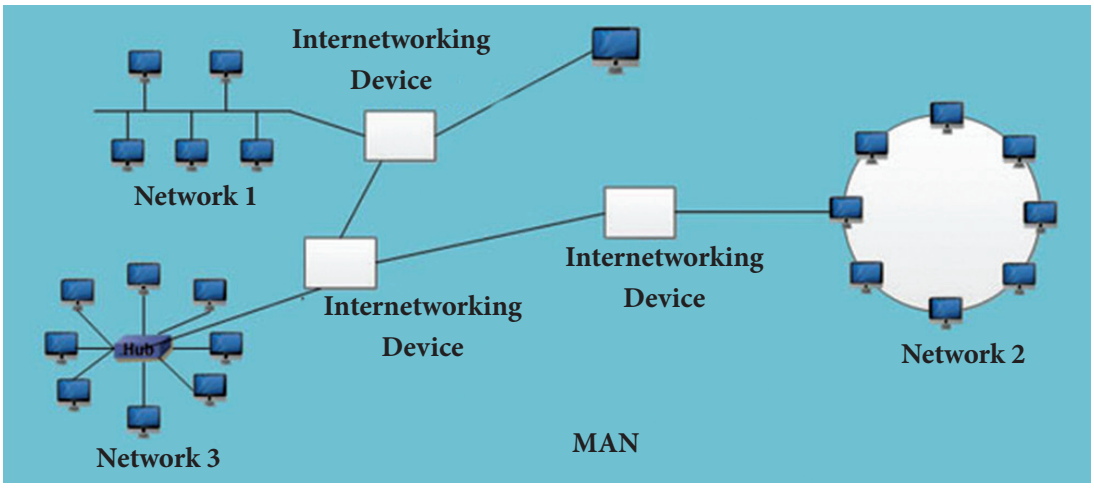


Figure 14.6 Metropolitan Area Network (MAN)

Advantages of MAN

- It is extremely efficient and provides fast communication via high-speed carriers, such as fibre optic cables.
- It provides a good back bone for large network and provides greater access to WANs.
- The dual bus used in MAN helps the transmission of data in both directions simultaneously.
- A MAN usually encompasses several blocks of a city or an entire city.

Wide area network (WAN)

A wide area network (WAN) is a telecommunication network. WANs connect LANs that may be on opposite sides of a building, across the country or around the world. Computers connected to a Wide Area Network are often connected through public networks, such as the telephone system. They can also be connected through leased lines or satellites. The largest WAN in existence is the Internet.

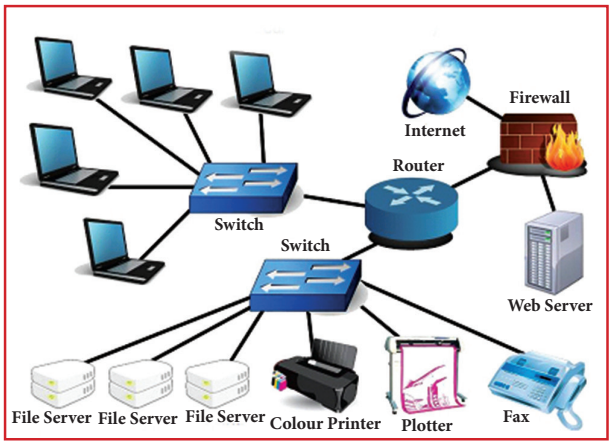


Figure 14.7 Wide area network

Advantages of WAN

- It covers a large geographical area.
- It shares software and resources with connecting workstations.
- Messages can be sent very quickly to anyone else on the network. These messages can have picture, sounds or data included with them (called attachments).
- Everyone on the network can use the same data. This avoids problems where some users may have older information than others.